

Dataset Overview:

- 21 variables covering 72,531 census tracts
- Complete data - 0% missing values across all variables
- 308.7 million people represented in 2010 Census data
- Coverage of all 51 jurisdictions including Alaska (167 tracts) and Hawaii (321 tracts)

Key Statistics:

- 41.8% of census tracts are low income
- 12.8% are classified as food deserts (LILA at 1/10 mile thresholds)
- 76.1% urban tracts vs 23.9% rural tracts
- California has the most census tracts (8,024), followed by Texas (5,238)

Data Sources:

- 2010 Census for population
- ACS 2014-2018 for income and vehicle data
- 2019 supermarket/grocery store lists for food access calculations

FOOD_ACCESS.CSV

Variable Name	Type	Description	Data Source(s)	Value Range	Collection Method
CensusTract	Geographic	Unique 11-digit census tract identifier (FIPS code)	U.S. Census Bureau	1,001,020,100 - 56,045,953,600	Administrative geographic coding
State	Categorical	Name of the U.S. state	U.S. Census Bureau	51 unique states	Administrative records
County	Geographic/Categorical	Name of the county	U.S. Census Bureau	1,877 unique counties	Administrative records

Urban	Categorical (Binary)	Flag indicating urban (1) or rural (0) tract	U.S. Census Bureau	0, 1	Census geographic classification
Pop2010	Quantitative	Total population in the census tract (2010 Census)	U.S. Census Bureau	1 - 37,452	Census enumeration
OHU2010	Quantitative	Number of occupied housing units (2010)	U.S. Census Bureau	0 - 16,043	Census enumeration
GroupQuartersFlag	Categorical (Binary)	Flag for tracts with significant group quarters population (1 = yes, 0 = no)	U.S. Census Bureau	0, 1	Census classification
LILATracts_1And10	Categorical (Binary)	Low Income and Low Access tract at 1 mile (urban) and 10 miles (rural)	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from census and store data

LILATracts_halfAnd10	Categorical (Binary)	Low Income and Low Access tract at 0.5 mile (urban) and 10 miles (rural)	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from census and store data
LILATracts_1And20	Categorical (Binary)	Low Income and Low Access tract at 1 mile (urban) and 20 miles (rural)	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from census and store data
LILATracts_Vehicle	Categorical (Binary)	Low Income and Low Access tract based on vehicle access	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from census and store data
HUNVFlag	Categorical (Binary)	Flag for tracts with low vehicle access (housing units with no vehicle)	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Census transportation data

LowIncomeTracts	Categorical (Binary)	Tract qualifies as low income (1 = yes, 0 = no)	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from census income data
LA1and10	Categorical (Binary)	Low access at 1 mile (urban) or 10 miles (rural)	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from store location data
LAhalfand10	Categorical (Binary)	Low access at 0.5 mile (urban) or 10 miles (rural)	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from store location data
LA1and20	Categorical (Binary)	Low access at 1 mile (urban) or 20 miles (rural)	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from store location data
LATracts_half	Categorical (Binary)	Low access tract at 0.5 mile threshold	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from store location data
LATracts1	Categorical (Binary)	Low access tract at 1 mile threshold	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from store location data
LATracts10	Categorical (Binary)	Low access tract at 10 mile threshold	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from store location data

LATracts20	Categorical (Binary)	Low access tract at 20 mile threshold	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	Calculated from store location data
LATractsVehicle_20	Categorical (Binary)	Low access tract considering vehicle access at 20 miles	USDA Food Access Research Atlas	0, 1	